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HERITAGE RAMP
(Opening spread)
 'Mul Mathi', a
 showcase of 22
 textile artworks by
 artists Madhvi and
 Manu Parekh in
 collaboration with
 Chanakya;
(top left) A toran
 crafted by the
 Chanakya School
 of Craft was
 mounted at the
 Gateway of India
 for Dior's Pre-Fall
 2023 showcase; a
 craftsman at work
 at the atelier

that integrates craft and design to equip its students with both technical and design know-how. It prepares them to join the industry or become entrepreneurs. It started with just eight students who had to be cajoled into joining, but now teaches over 100 in each batch.

Swali and Chiuri have known each other for nearly three decades. "There was an immediate connection as she comes from Solento, Italy, an area famous for its artisanal legacies. We bonded over how craft is a tangible way to reflect our heritage," says Swali. Since then, they have been working together. "It's been an extremely fulfilling journey where we have understood how globally these communities need to be recognised, preserved, and celebrated," says Swali.

BLURRING BOUNDARIES

Chanakya primarily works in three verticals. There is a space for art where it enters into artistic collaborations with different artists around the world. It works with artists such as New York-based painter Mickalene Thomas, French artist Eva Jospin, and the New Delhi-based Parekhs. "What we do together is blur the lines between craft and art to create a new language collectively that celebrates craft excellence," says Swali. As part of the Dior show, a public exhibition of 22 large-scale textile artworks by Manu